

Student:in: Aranguren Barragan Camilo Andres
Studiengang: Applied Information and Data Science
Major:
Titel der Arbeit: Electoral Closeness and Incumbency
Advantage In Spain
Betreuer:in: Schmid Lukas
Vertraulich (leer=nein):

Beurteilung Vorstudie Master Thesis Projekt	Punkte	Beurteilung
- Die Vorstudie folgt einem einheitlichen, vorgegebenen Aufbau, der im Master-Thesis-Reglement beschrieben ist. Die Vorstudie soll im Kern sicherstellen, dass das Master-Thesis-Projekt gute Erfolgschancen hat. - Die inhaltliche Beurteilung der Vorstudie folgt den untenstehenden 12 Leitfragen. Der Referent/die Referentin bewertet die Leistung für jedes Kriterium auf einer Skala von 1 («trifft überhaupt nicht zu») bis 10 («trifft voll und ganz zu»). Die Bewertung wird kurz begründet. - Die Vorstudie muss mindestens mit der gerundeten Note 4.0 bewertet werden, um zu erfüllen. - Bei der Bewertung der Vorstudie mit einer gerundeten Note 3.5 haben die Studierenden die Möglichkeit, die Vorstudie zu überarbeiten, um die erste Leistungsbewertung auf die Note 4.0 zu verbessern. Die Überarbeitung muss im Rahmen des Zeitplanes des laufenden Master-Thesis-Projekts möglich sein. - Für Studierende mit einer Bewertung von unter einer gerundeten Note 3.5 besteht die Möglichkeit, die Vorstudie zu einem neuen Thema im nachfolgenden Semester zu wiederholen. - Der Referent/die Referentin führen mit jedem Kandidaten/jeder Kandidatin ein Feedbackgespräch. Das vorliegende Beurteilungsraster bildet den Gesprächsleitfaden. - Die Vorstudie wird mit 6 ECTS-Punkten gewichtet.		
Gesamtbeurteilung	4.5	
Praxisrelevanz:	6	
<i>The relevance of the topic is well outlined in the first sections. However, the problem statement and motivation is too close to the research article by Luechinger, Schelker, and Schmid (2024). The thesis should have a contribution</i>		

<i>independent of the original article.</i>	
Thematische Eingrenzung: <i>The topic of the thesis is clear and it makes sense to look at this in the context of a master thesis. However, the preliminary study only lists treatment and outcomes and it should describe them in more detail why they are interesting to look at.</i>	6
Zentrale Forschungsfrage: <i>The research questions are clearly defined and the author has own ideas how to analyze further outcomes (district magnitude, list positions). However, those subquestions should be motivated by theoretical literature which is completely absent</i>	6
Inhaltliches Vorgehen: <i>The procedure is clear.</i>	10
Methodisches Vorgehen: <i>The thesis will apply a regression discontinuity design described in section "Initial Considerations Regarding Methodology". The RDD is not explained in detail and the rdrobust packages are not listed as part of the software the author will use. The estimation strategy is only two sentences.</i>	6
Daten: <i>The candidate has the relevant data and know the relevant data. However, he does not present any evidence about the data, only the total number of observations. It is thus unclear whether he already knows what is in the data.</i>	6
Technische Hilfsmittel: <i>Candidate has good knowledge of Python and lists the relevant packages in the chapter "Technology, software and applications" . Most of these packages, though, are standard Python packages with the exception of LinkTransformer to do the record linkage. The specialized package rdrobust is not mentioned and discussed.</i>	8
Projektrisiken: <i>Detailed list of project risks and respective mitigation strategies. Regarding the small sample: It is not clear what the candidate means with "fixed effects" which are not mentioned in other sections of the preliminary study. The risk "Measurement error in the running variable" seems something which cannot be mitigated due to the available data. But it is not a big risk as this data has been used to assign seats and therefore all a researcher can get. The risk "Endogeneity of list positions" is not a risks because it is an outcome and a channel/mechanism when looking at success in the next election.</i>	8
Arbeits- und Forschungsplan: <i>Yes, the candidate provides a a detailed work plan in "Work Packages and Schedule" which seems reasonable to me. However, the specifics of the</i>	8
Forschungsliteratur: <i>The preliminary study has not yet delved into the literature. The master thesis should have a solid theoretical background for both the main hypothesis (impact of incumbency on reelection probability/number of votes/list position) but also for the heterogeneous effects (parties, district magnitude) the candidate mentions.</i>	6

Formale Standards: 9

Language is fine, but the chapters and subchapters should be subsequently numbered.

Innovationsgehalt: 9

The author should be more specific why we are looking at Spain and why the incumbency advantage is Spain is something we should care about. He may also point out how Spain is different/similar to countries for which we already have a sense of the incumbency advantage.

Ungerundete Note Beurteilung Vorstudie Master Thesis Projekt

4.5

Gesamteindruck / Kommentar Ko-Examinator:in:

Two main points need to be addressed in the final thesis: First, the hypotheses should come from the literature and should be better motivated. Second, the preliminary study does not explain how the author will implement the regression discontinuity framework. The respective Python packages are not mentioned. Other points are laid out above.

Schlussnote Beurteilung Vorstudie Master Thesis Projekt

4.5